

Robert Swanger

Ankeny, IA | r.swanger@live.com | linkedin.com/in/robert-swangerit

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student and self-directed learner with hands-on experience building and administering a virtualized small-business network environment. Proficient in firewall configuration, SIEM deployment, Active Directory, and OSINT techniques through independent lab work. Former U.S. Army infantryman with a proven record of precision, accountability, and performance under pressure. Actively pursuing CompTIA certifications and seeking an IT internship to apply technical skills in a professional environment.

SKILLS

Security & Networking: pfSense, Suricata IDS/IPS, Wazuh SIEM, firewall rule design, network segmentation, TCP/IP, DHCP, DNS

Systems: Windows 10/11, Windows Server 2022 (AD DS, Group Policy), Kali Linux, Ubuntu

Virtualization: VMware Workstation Pro, multi-VM lab design, NIC topology, VMnet segmentation, IP addressing strategy

Tools: Wireshark, Nmap, Sherlock, holehe, recon-ng, Git, Linux CLI, OBS Studio

Support: Tier 1 technical support, remote diagnostics, ticketing systems, escalation coordination, non-technical user communication

PROJECTS

Cybersecurity Home Lab

- Designed and built a full virtualized network topology from scratch, independently determining NIC count, VMnet segmentation, and IP addressing strategy
- Deployed pfSense firewall/router with Suricata IDS/IPS on WAN/LAN interfaces to simulate real-world perimeter defense
- Deployed Wazuh SIEM server receiving alerts from agents on a Windows Server 2022 AD DS domain controller and two domain-joined Windows 10 clients
- Configured Active Directory Domain Services including DNS, Group Policy, and domain-joined endpoints
- Conducted OSINT self-audit using Kali Linux toolset (holehe, Sherlock, recon-ng, PhoneInfoga); produced a written findings report documenting personal digital exposure and stored results in an encrypted VeraCrypt container
- Configured a Kali Linux VM for penetration testing of the virtual network; documented all procedures and results in a versioned Obsidian vault

EDUCATION

Des Moines Area Community College (DMACC)

AAS, Cybersecurity.

Ankeny, IA

Aug 2026 – Present

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA A+ Core 1 & Core 2 — self-study in progress, exam targeted before October 2026
- Planned: CompTIA Network+, Security+, CySA+

EXPERIENCE

IT Support Technician

Cox Communications

May 2014 – Nov 2014

Omaha, NE

- Delivered front-line technical support to approximately 50-60 customers per day, diagnosing internet, TV, and phone connectivity and equipment issues via phone and remote tools
- Documented symptoms, troubleshooting steps, and resolutions in ticketing system; coordinated with field technicians and escalation teams
- Guided non-technical users through modem/router resets, in-home network setups, and equipment troubleshooting; consistently received above-average performance ratings

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

United States Army

Infantry Soldier

Sep 2004 – Mar 2011

- Combat deployment to Iraq; awarded Army Commendation Medal with V Device (valor) and Combat Infantryman Badge. Operated under high-stress conditions requiring precision, accountability, team coordination, and strict procedural adherence.